THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION
PARIS BRANCH

NOTICE OF THE ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING 2013

To be held at 28, rue des Acacias, 75017, Paris
On Monday 25th November, 2013 at 18h30

All members, may attend and speak at the AGM. Only those members who have paid their subscription by Friday, 16th November may vote. Please find attached the ruling on Proxy voting, as drawn up by the Branch Committee, following instructions from the 2001 AGM.

Nominations for the Committee must be made by a Member and seconded. The consent of the nominees must be obtained. All nominations must be returned to the Branch Secretary before Monday 18th November.

Members may make proposals for consideration at the AGM., provided that they reach the Branch Secretary before Wednesday 20th November.

The minutes of the previous AGM., are attached together with the accounts. Please remember to bring them with you to the AGM., together with this notice.

A G E N D A

The Exhortation & Silent Tribute

Apologies for absence

Minutes of the previous AGM

Matters arising from the Minutes

Chairman's Report on the Year's work

Treasurer's Report

Welfare Report

Election of Officers and Committee

Resolutions of which notice has been given

Any Other Business

ASSEMBLEE GENERALE ANNUELLE 2012

L'assemblée aura lieu au 28 rue des Acacias, 75017 Paris
le Lundi 25 novembre 2013 à 18h30

Tous les membres peuvent assister et prendre la parole à l'assemblée générale annuelle. Seuls les membres qui ont réglé leur cotisation avant le mercredi 16 novembre peuvent voter. Veuillez trouver ci-joint le règlement en ce qui concerne le vote par procuration, tel qu'il a été rédigé par le Comité, selon les instructions de l'AGA de 2001.

Chaque candidat au comité sera proposé par un membre et appuyé par un deuxième membre. Le consentement préalable des candidats est indispensable. Toutes les candidatures devraient arriver chez le secrétaire avant le mercredi 20 novembre.

Les membres peuvent soumettre des propositions à l'assemblée à condition que le secrétaire en reçoive notification avant le mercredi 20 novembre.

Ci-joint : le procès-verbal de l'AGA 2012 et les comptes pour 2013. Veuillez les apporter avec vous à l'AGA avec le présent avis.

A G E N D A

L'Exhortation et Hommage silencieux

Excuses

Adoption du procès-verbal de l'AGA précédente

Questions découlant du procès-verbal

Rapport du Président sur les activités de l'année

Rapport du trésorier

Rapport sur les actions d'assistance et d'aide

Election au Comité

Propositions reçues

Questions diveses

THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION
PARIS BRANCH

ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING 2012

FOR YEAR 1st OCTOBER 2011 – 30TH SEPTEMBER 2012

The Paris Branch Annual General Meeting was held at 28, rue des Acacias, 75017 Paris, on Monday 19th November, 2012 at 18h30. The Chairman, Mr. R. Thorn, invited all members to stand for the Exhortation and Silent Tribute and to remember Pamela Hastings, Rosemary Bateau-Clubb and former Vice-Chairman, Jack Wicker.

There were 27 members present with three guests, which included Mr. John Crothers, Organist of the combined Choir of the various British Churches in Paris, Mr. Andrew Holford, Concert Trumpeter and Mr. John Greenwood, Auditor of the Paris Branch. The Chairman welcomed them all.

Apologies for Absence : Apologies were received from Mesdames Bean, Burkard, Hicks, Mann, Thourot and Zomerplaag and from Messrs. Auduc, Baker, Corrigan, Gould, Liberman, Maloubier, G. Morris, S. Morris, Peridi, G. Warby, R. Warby, Weatherlake and Zomerplaag. We had received 11 proxy votes from amongst these members.

Minutes of the Previous A.G.M. : The Chairman asked if the minutes of the 8th December, 2011 AGM could be accepted as a true record, signed and dated. This was agreed with no matters arising. These minutes were proposed by Mr. C. Spencer-Bernard and seconded by Mr. G. Scott.

Chairman's Report : The Chairman said that our year had been dominated by the death in September of our former Vice-Chairman and friend, Jack Wicker. He will be greatly missed as will the two ladies mentioned earlier in this report.

The Chairman said he would like to welcome as well as the three gentlemen mention above, The Rev. Robert Varty from Caen.

Welfare : Welfare will always be our Raison d'être. David bean will report later on Welfare activities during the past year. We continue to contribute to the British Charitable Fund, a procedure which has been authorized by RBL London following an Internal Audit conducted in 1999, when the internal auditor from London met with the BCF and saw how the Poppy funds were being appropriately applied in meeting the needs of our eligible candidates. This approval is sought and given every year. This year we contributed 10,500€, 500€ more than in recent years, following another successful Poppy Appeal Campaign. Our beneficiaries receive allowances totaling approximately 4 times that amount, so representing a very satisfactory gearing. Every year the BCF send us a statement of the monies received by our names candidates. I would like to thank Charles Spencer-Bernard who has joined our Welfare team. We now have four Branch members who are qualified caseworkers. Thanks also to our case-workers, Elizabeth and David Bean.

Poppy Appeal : Since the AGM is one month earlier than was usual in the past we do not yet have complete results of this year's Poppy Appeal. I would like to thank Miss Gilhooley and her helpers to date, Janet Warby and George Mutch.

Ceremonies since the last A.G.M. : Our principal Annual Ceremonies are the Ravivage de La Flamme, 4th August. This year it was the turn of the Australians to be our guests and the Ambassador, Mr. Ric Wells, did the honours of lighting the flame. This was followed by a Reception in the Clubhouse.

Notre Dame 2012 saw an exceptionally high turnout for the Service of Remembrance. We thank our Chaplain, Canon Philip Mounstephen for his Order of Service, and for giving the sermon. Canon Mounstephen came back specially for this Service, having already left his post as Chaplain of St. Michael's, Paris to become the new Director of the Church Missionary Society, based in Oxford. We give warm thanks for his dedication to the affairs of the RBL Paris Branch. His wife Ruth told me that Philip was very moved and motivated by what he was of the work and ethos of the RBL. So his dedication was his way of thanking us for that experience. We did not manage to secure the services of our star cornet player, L/Cpl Robert Parry, Coldstream Guards, because he was on duty that day at the Cenotaph. Instead we found talent close to hand in Andrew Holford, a member of the RAFA, who is a concert trumpeter. But this time he didn't blow his own trumpet, but wrote to Aldershot to buy an Army bugle, with cord. This he played to perfection. He said he had started to play the bugle as a schoolboy of eight, and later in his CCF band. Our usual piper and Branch member Murdoch McCleod played the pipes for us with his usual panache, having flown in from Edinburgh.

We would wish to have our Service filmed another year, but sponsorship will be required to be in a position to pay a film company. Warm thanks to Canon Philip Mounstephen, Roger and Janet Warby, Chief Usher David Bean, the Choir and Organist John Crothers.

Other Ceremonies : February 11th saw us at the annual ceremony at Bennecourt, which is twinned with Coldstream. The Branch was represented by Maire Didier Dumont, the Chairman, Joseph and Françoise Sigward and Lt. Pierre Quenot. A detachment of the Coldstream Guards took part.

April 22nd saw us at Maisons-Laffitte for the annual ceremony at the RAF Memorial in the Park. The Branch was represented by Jack Wicker, David and Elizabeth Bean, Roger and Janet Warby.

In May David and Elizabeth Bean, Noreen and Jacques Riols, Bob Maloubier and Joseph and Françoise Sigward represented the Paris Branch at the Annual S.O.E., Ceremony at Valençay.

On 25th August the Chairman represented the Branch and his Regiment at the Ceremonies at and near Vernon (Eure) to commemorate the Liberation of the town on that date in 1944 by 6 Infantry county regiments, the 1st Worcesters, the 4th Somerset Light Infantry, the 4th and 5th Wiltshires, and the 5th Cornwall Light Infantry.

On 2nd September the Paris branch was represented at the Annual cycle rally Pedal to Paris, culminating in the laying of Poppy Wreath at the Tomb of the Unknown Soldier. We learnt that this event raises £500,000 for the Poppy Appeal. John Farmer, RBL National Chairman laid the wreath.

On 25th September, jointly with the Paris Branch of the RNVRA we attended a ceremony at the graveside of Admiral Sir Bertram Ramsay in Saint Germain-en-Laye Old Cemetery.

Funeral of Jack Wicker, OBE : The Paris Branch was well represented at the Funeral of Jack Wicker at Holy Trinity Church, Maisons-Laffitte on 1st October. We thank Janet and Roger Warby for carrying the Union Flag and branch standard.

The Chairman attended a Service of Remembrance at The British School of Paris and addressed the school on the origins and work of the RBL and on the story of the Poppy.

The Battlefield Visit this year was to Arnhem on 19th – 21st October, once more under the guidance of Colonel Oliver Warman, late Welsh Guards. It has been suggested that the 2013 tour take place at Dunkirk. A large number of Welsh Guardsmen are buried in the cemetery at Boulogne-sur-Mer, where related fighting also took place.

Membership : Paris branch membership numbers, having drifted downwards in recent years, have now stabilized since 2010. We are determined to concentrate on drumming up additional members here in Paris, where we judge there is a fund of good-will towards us in the British Community. Mailing cost of Branch papers to members are naturally high, and we continue to use e-mail to communicate with members who are electronically connected; that percentage of e-members is now over 60% and rising. Our thanks to Mark Yates for his many hours of administration and for his skillful work as our Webmaster.

Social events in the RBL year : We held our Christmas lunch on 16th December, 2011, the Christmas Mess Night was held on 18th December, 2011.

The Poppy 'Thank You', Standard Bearers' and New Members' Cocktail was held on 7th March, 2012

On 6th November, 2012, Les Clack, Trish Kessler and Chloe Dunn gave War Poetry readings

The Annual Poppy Coffee Morning was held in the Ambassador's Residence on 8th November 2012. Lady Ricketts was our hostess. We would like to thank Lady Ricketts, Joan Hicks, Janet Warby, Carmen Thourot, Vicky Millett and David Bean for organising this event.

Co-propriété : Thanks to the late Jack Wicker for representing us most effectively on the Co-Propriété Committee both in rue Boudreau and now in rue des Acacias. Charles Spencer-Bernard has kindly agreed to represent us in future. Thank you Charles.

House Manager : Monthly lunches recommenced in 2010 with a wide range of cuisine, and we thank Tony Bennett warmly for catering for those lunches. We have received a donation in the form of a T.V. set and we will consider organizing film evenings in the New Year, and we will also establish whether International Rugby afternoons can be organized with Paris Welsh and Caledonian Societies. I would also like to thank Ben Galang for the help he gives to Tony and for his devoted attention to the cleaning of our premises.

Fund-raising : The Sweepstakes and Tombola will be reported on in the Treasurer's report later. I just wanted to say here how grateful we are to members for their faithful support which the Treasurer appreciates enormously. Thank you therefore to all the members who support us in this way.

Relations with the British Embassy : The Ambassador is our Patron in France, H.M. The Queen, of course remaining our Royal Patron. Many thanks to Sir Peter Ricketts, Air Commodore John Maas and Wing Commander Graham August for their continued support. I am writing to Sir Peter and Lad Ricketts to thank them for their ready support of the RBL since their arrival in Paris. The good news is that a new Military Attaché is already in post, and will take up his duties shortly upon completion of his training. His is Colonel James Murray-Playfair, former C.O. of the 2nd Battalion, The Royal Regiment of Fusiliers. His last post was also in Paris as the Senior British Liaison Officer to the French Etat-Major de l'Armée de Terre.

Branch Committee : Many thanks to our hard-working officers and committee. I don't know if you realize how many hours of voluntary work are put in by our Secretary and Treasurer, and without them this branch would grind to a halt. Could I invite you to show your appreciation in the usual way. I would draw your attention in particular to the enormous work-load shouldered by our Secretary and by our Social Secretary, Joan Hicks. David Blanchard started the year as Acting Treasurer. Last year you paid him a warm tribute for his 21 years as Treasurer, and for his enormous assistance to the Secretary and to myself. Imagine now how delighted we are to welcome his co-opted successor Ian McDonald to his first AGM. Not only has he had to learn the ropes from zero, but he has had to prepare his accounts one month earlier than we have had to in the past. This put added strain on him, but as you will have seen he has met his deadline and we thank him warmly.

We note that long-time Committee members Ken Davey and David Edwards are not standing this year. May I thank them warmly on your behalf for their devoted service to the branch and to the Legion. Ken is now incapacitated and can no longer get around. David spends a large part of the year out of the country and he is generously making way for some keen volunteers who are standing for election later in our AGM. Thanks therefore must go to Ken Davey and David Edwards for their past services and to Jon Cooper, Peter Huggins, Stephen Parry and James Weatherlake for agreeing to stand.

The future : In 2013 the Paris Branch and The Royal British Legion celebrated the 60th Anniversary of the Coronation of our Royal Patron, H.M. The Queen. Your Committee is planning a Commonwealth Celebratory Cocktail at the Ecole Militaire in June, and this event is booked for Friday 14th June 2013. H.M. British Ambassador, our Patron in France, has already accepted our invitation to be our main guest, and we now intend to invite the Commonwealth ambassadors and service attachés.

As members will recall I reported at the last AGM that The Royal British Legion in London had wished to see a District set up in France. In Legion-speak this meant the equivalent of a County Committee in the UK. In the event there was not a majority of the French Branches in favour of this proposal, and the plan was dropped. I can report that to date there has been no follow-up by London to the original proposal.

At the Business schools we teach students to carry out a first analysis of a company's health by identifying its current Strengths and Weaknesses, and the Opportunities and the Threats for the future. If we do this for RBL Paris Branch we could draw up the following lists :

Our Strengths are :

- That we have a very loyal membership,
- We have a very motivated management team on the Committee
- We have our own well-situated premises, whose purchase was financed by the
- Sale of the premises in rue Boudreau. The Clubhouse at the latter address was a
- Far-sighted original investment by our predecessors in 1953.
- The disposal of Boudreau and the purchase of Acacias left us with a capital surplus, Which is currently invested.
- With the aid of our subscription income, donations, rental income, Tombolas and Sweepstakes we balance our books on current account.
- The RBL and its Poppy has a strong brand image. Flowing from that there is a fund of good-will among the British community in Paris; the Notre Dame Service of Remembrance is packed every year without any publicity.

Our Weakness is :

- Principally demographic, as is true of the RBL as a whole. The average age of our Membership is probably nearer 70 than 60. We have representatives of the Second World War veterans and of the National Service generation, but for many

reasons the next generation of both servicemen and civilians is not well represented.

Opportunities :

- Our strengths present us with opportunities, and the challenge is to try to eliminate our weakness by bridging the generation gap. That means a rethink of our attractiveness to the younger generation, which almost certainly means a development of activities designed to do precisely that. We have cheaper beer than the pubs for example.

The Threats :

- Principally are that we do not find a solution to the generation gap.
- That our share of the Welfare provision in France continues to dwindle in the face of SSAFA whose approach may be described as that of a network of special forces whose activities are orchestrated, but since they have no permanent structure they have no fixed costs. With many troops on the ground, they often operate in areas not covered by the RBL branches. Perhaps with our fellow RBL branches we should examine whether we are sufficiently pro-active in making our services known.

Finally a word about the nature of British clubs and of the Royal British Legion in particular. The RBL brings so many different people together in a common cause. Whether you were a Brigadier or a Bombardier, an Air Commodore or an Aircraftsman, a Ship's Captain or a Ship's Cook, everyone mucks in to do the job in hand. It is that fellowship which makes a club, and I hope the Paris Branch will maintain that fine tradition. There was an echo of this leveling when we saw that Admiral Ramsay was buried alongside the members of the crew flying his plane to Brussels.

Thank you for your attention.

Treasurer's Report : The Treasurer said he was pleased to present, for the first time, the annual accounts for our financial year ended September 30, 2012. But before doing so he would like to officially record his thanks to Mr. David Blanchard, the outgoing Treasurer. The Paris Branch has been very fortunate to have been able to count on the services of a professional such as David Blanchard and this will be a hard act to follow. He said he would also like to thank Mr. Blanchard for all his time and patience in handing over the role of Treasurer to him, both in the day to day running of the financial affairs of the branch and in the preparation of these accounts.

Administration Fund :

Income : This year our operating expenditure exceeded our income by €767, an improvement on last year when our expenditure exceeded income from operations by €1,652.

Net fund raising income was stable (-€102) with good increases in subscriptions, donations and tombola being offset by decreases in sweepstakes and social events.

There was a reduction of €987 in our total cost of recurring operations compared to last year, mainly due to decreased reception costs of €2,072, (last year the figure included the 90th anniversary celebrations), although this was offset by cost increases in several categories, most notably premises costs which went up by €679.

Balance Sheet : Our net assets stand at €548,044 and the Administration Fund cash position is €37,690. We still have a healthy balance on deposit at the bank.

Poppy Appeal Fund : Donations and poppy sales were up by nearly €3,000 over last year, an increase of nearly 22%. Relief payments made to the British Charitable Fund were €10,500 and other welfare payments totaled €694. Provision had been made for a further payment of €2,500 which will be made shortly to the British Charitable Fund.

We show a net excess of income over outgoings for the year of €2,446 and the Poppy Appeal Fund cash position stands at €10,243

Audit : The accounts as presented to the meeting have been audited.

The Chairman thanked Mr. McDonald for his report and asked the floor for any questions. There being none the Chairman asked for the Financial Statement to be proposed and seconded. The report was proposed by Mr. G. Scott and seconded by Mr. D. Bean.

The Chairman said he would like to thank Mr. John Greenwood in this his first Audit of our accounts. The Auditor said the branch was well set up for the future.

Welfare Report : Mr. Bean reported that this had been a quiet year. We have two ongoing cases and at present have four Welfare Caseworkers. Mr. Bean said it is good that it has been quiet but we must not become complacent. Mr. Bean said he would also like to thank the British Charitable Fund for their help. Mr. Bean said that he had been approached by RBL London to become a Training Officer for the branches in France, Belgium and Holland. Mr. Bean had recently conducted training sessions in Brittany and Poitou-Charente areas. Every Caseworker has to re-train every two years by law. The Chairman thanked Mr. Bean for his report.

Election of Officers & Committee : The Chairman said that Mr. O.G. Longley, had agreed to serve as our Hon. President for the next year. The Chairman asked Mr. Longley if he would like to announce the names of the Officers and Committee who had agreed to stand once more. Mr. Longley said the nominations for Officers were :

Chairman	Roger Thorn
Vice-Chairman	David Bean
Hon. Treasurer	Ian McDonald
Hon. Secretary	Janet Warby

The following were elected to the Committee : Miss J. Hicks, Mme. N. Riols, Miss V. Millet, Messrs. Bennett, Blanchard, Cockle, Cooper, Dumont, Gould, Huggins, Parry, Spencer-Bernard, Weatherlake and Yates

The following are invited to become ex-Officio Members on our Committee : Col. D. Jacir, ANAP, Mr. G. Scott, RAFA, Mme. G. Corrigan, 40/8 Society and Mme. P. Levalleur, Free French.

The Officers were voted into office and the Committee were elected en bloc. The nominations were proposed by Mr. D. Edwards and Baron R. Gillespie. The Chairman said the next Committee Meeting would be held on Thursday 17th January 2013.

Any Other Business : Miss Gilhooley asked the Chairman if the Charity Ceilidh would be going ahead. The Chairman confirmed it would be to which Miss Gilhooley said that the Committee needed to help. The Ceilidh would be held on Friday 7th December at St. Michael's Church hall.

The Chairman mentioned that Mr. Longley and Mr. Scott had books on sale at the moment. Mr. Longley's is about his life before, during and after the Second World War, the title of Mr. Longley's book is 'To Hell with that!' Mr. Scott's book is called Remembrance. It has some beautiful colour 'photo's and some are from Camp Bastian in Afghanistan. Some of the 'photo's are of Mr. Scott's own family. There is soon to be a paperback version out. The profits from Mr. Longley's book will be devided between the British Hospital in Paris and The Royal British Legion, Paris Branch. The profits from Mr. Scott's book will be devided between the RBL Paris Branch and RAFA Ile de France Branch.

Mme. Corrigan gave a short report on the activities of the 40/8 Society and the former Chess Section.

Mr. Edwards asked what the relationship between SAAFA and the RBL was. The Chairman and Mr. Bean said that there is no integration between the two and we do not have any problems. There are also a couple of other Charitable organizations that we sometimes work with and these are The Elizabeth Finn and Officers Associations.

Mr. Longley said he would like to thank the Chairman for maintaining a tight ship.

Mr. Riols asked if it would be possible to have a copy of the Branch membership list sent to each member for reference, Mr. Yates replied that this might contravene the Data Protection Act and therefore we would not be happy in doing this.

There being no further business, the meeting was closed at 19h47.

ROYAL BRITISH LEGION - PARIS BRANCH

ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING, 25th NOVEMBER 2013

TREASURER'S REPORT

BRANCH ACCOUNTS FOR THE 9 MONTHS ENDED 30th JUNE 2013

I am pleased to present to the AGM the Branch Accounts for the Paris Branch.

Before going into the detail there are two points that I would like to mention specifically, as they represent a break with past practice:

1. The Legion decided some time ago that the accounting period for branches would change and the "Field Year", as it is called at RBL London, would end on 30th June, as of 2013. The main reason for this is to give more time to the Finance team at RBL HQ to prepare the consolidated accounts for the charity, which still cover the year from October 1 to September 30. The only impact that this has had for us is that the Branch Accounts presented to you cover, exceptionally, the **9 months** from 1st October 2012 to 30th June 2013. The next set of accounts will be for the 12-month period from 1st July 2013 to 30th June 2014.

2. After reviewing the reporting requirements for our Association Loi 1901 (the local legal structure of the Paris Branch of RBL), and of course after referring to and discussing with both David Blanchard, the previous Treasurer and John Greenwood, our Honorary Auditor, the decision has been taken not to produce a Balance Sheet. There is no requirement locally to produce this document and it is not part of the financial reporting package that we send to RBL in London. After discussion with the Chairman, Vice-Chairman and Secretary, all were in agreement with my suggestion. This has considerably simplified the process of producing the figures.

Therefore my presentation covers the document that RBL London calls the Branch Accounts and focuses on the income and expenditure of the Paris Branch.

One other point should made - in the past both this document and the Balance Sheet that you are used to seeing have included an estimation of the value of the premises at rue des Acacias, but this year RBL London has decided to carry out all the valuations centrally and branches have been given the specific instruction not to complete the 'Property Value' boxes at line 39 (page 3) or line 41 (page 4). This means that is not possible to indicate the Total Net Assets of Branch (line 46).

Turning now to the presentation of the document: -

Administration Fund/General Account (pages 2 & 3):

- **Receipts and Payments (pages 2 and 3)**

For the 9 months in question the surplus on the General Account was €952, compared to €1110 for the 12 month period last year,

Despite the shorter period total receipts (income) were stable, (€11 203 v €11 049), with net fundraising income up by €1 285 to €3 610 (Net Sweepstake and Tombola income accounted for €899 of this increase, the remainder comes from other fund-raising events such as monthly lunches). However net subscription income was down by 9.6% and in the current low interest rate environment, Interest Received was significantly lower, even though the balances on deposit have changed little.

Branch Administration costs at €1 634 remain under tight control, although please remember that this is a 9 month figure, so the comparable annual figure would be in the range €2 000-€2 200, compared with €2 445 for the last full year. Premises costs of €6 397 (which the Legion classifies as "Property Transactions") are up on a like for like basis, as the annual rate would be €8000-€8500, compared with €6458 last year. The main reason for this is the cost of property improvements undertaken during the year.

- **Bank and Cash Balances (page 4)**

The **Administration Fund/General Account** cash position has increased by the surplus of €952 to €38 642. We still have a healthy balance on deposit at the bank.

Poppy Appeal Fund/Welfare Account (pages 3 & 4):

- **Donations and poppy sales** for the 9 months were at the same level as the previous full year (€15 846 v €16 140). Relief payments made to the British Charitable Fund increased by €2 000 to €12 500 and other welfare payments totalled €93.
- We show a net excess of income over outgoings for the year of € 2 278 and the **Poppy Appeal Fund/Welfare Account** cash position stands at €16 025.

Audit and Submission to RBL London

The Branch Committee approved these figures at their meeting in September and our Auditor, John Greenwood, subsequently signed them off. They were then sent to RBL London together with supporting documentation.

The Branch Accounts are now presented to you at this Annual General Meeting and confirmation of the approval that I ask you now to give will be confirmed by the Branch Secretary on Page 1 of the document and resent to London.

Ian McDonald

Honorary Treasurer
25th November 2013

BRANCH ACCOUNTS

For the period ended 30 June 2013

Branch	Paris, France
County/District	Overseas
Branch Contact Address	28 rue des Acacias, 75017 Paris, France
Branch Code	BR3441

Branch Certificate

The summaries of Receipts & Payments and of Branch Assets and Liabilities which include all funds held by the Branch or held on their behalf were approved by the Branch Committee on 19th September 2013 and we confirm that there are no other accounts or assets relating to the Branch which are not included here.

We confirm that during the period from 1 October 2012 to 30 June 2013, the Trustees have carried out their duties in accordance with the Royal Charter and the Management Handbook, including the duty to maintain proper accounting records and to safeguard the property and funds of the Branch.
We confirm that members of the Committee have been informed of this duty.

Signed _____ Chairman Signed _____ Vice-Chairman

Signed _____ Treasurer Signed _____ Secretary

Report of the Independent Examiner

(Note: Where the accounts are subject to audit, the Auditor must submit an Audit Report in the format prescribed by their professional standards and attach it to the Accounts)

In accordance with the Terms of Reference issued by the Board of Trustees of The Royal British Legion, I/we have examined the summary of Receipts and Payments in the General Account, Benevolent Account, Property Transactions and Other Funds for the period ended 30 June 2013 and of the Branch Assets and Liabilities as at that date, together with the books and vouchers relating to those summaries.

In my/our opinion, the said summaries fairly state the transactions of the Branch for the period ended 30 June 2013, and its Assets and Liabilities at that date.

Except where stated below (*if none then state none*), no matter has come to my/our attention which gives reasonable cause to believe that:

- proper accounting records have not been kept; or
- the Branch Accounts are not prepared in accordance with the books and supporting vouchers; or
- the Branch does not have proper title to the assets and stated bank balances; or
- the Branch has not complied with Legion policies and accounting requirements.

Matters to report:

☐ I have checked bank statements, bank reconciliations and attached copies of bank statements are correct.

☐ I have checked Investment Reports and attached copies of Investments reports are correct, (if applicable).

Signed _____ Qualification _____ Date _____

Print Name John Greenwood

Address:
54 ave du Vallon, 78450 Chavenay, France Contact Number 00 33 1 30 54 34 11

Annual General Meeting

These Accounts were adopted by the Annual General Meeting of the Branch on .....

Signed.....Secretary

This form must be completed, audited (or examined by an Independent Examiner) and the **original** sent to your County Secretary before 30 September 2013 together with stapled **copies** of all relevant bank accounts statements showing the balance at 30 June 2013. One photocopy (or scanned copy) to be retained by the Auditor/Examiner (as required) and one photocopy to be retained by the Branch. Please note that the Accounts should be submitted to County/District office **prior to approval at AGM.**

Branch Name	GENERAL ACCOUNT	Branch Code
Paris, France **ACCOUNTS IN EUROS**	RECEIPTS AND PAYMENTS SUMMARY FOR NINE MONTHS ENDED 30 JUNE 2013	BR3441

Membership Statistics: Current Year

DD Payer No.	Branch Fee	Life	Member	Excused	Youth	Total Members
3	€37/46	No. 0	No. 180	No. 0	No. 0	180

		Current Period		Prior Year	
	Receipts	30/06/2013		30/09/2012	
1.	Gross Subscriptions Collected	6107		6463	
	Less: Membership Fees paid out	2099		2030	
	Subscriptions Retained by the Branch		4008		4433
2.	**Branch Poppy Appeal Events**				
	Events Receipts				
	Less: Events Expenses				
	Less: Paid over to Poppy Appeal				
	Appeal Receipts Retained (should be nil)				
3.	**Branch Fundraising Events**				
	Fundraising Receipts	15510		9530	
	Less: Fundraising Expenses	11900		7205	
	Net Fundraising income		3610		2325
4.	**Branch Social Events (net of costs)**		717		676
5a	**Monetary Gifts & Donations**		2340		2672
5b	**Legacies Received**				
6.	**Interest Received on General Fund Accounts**		274		925
	Income from Investments				
7.	**Other Income**				
	Charters,Badges,Wreaths etc		254		18
	Proceeds from Sale of Investments				
	Other (specify)				
8.	**Total Receipts (add 1 to 7)**		€ 11 203		€ 11 049
	Payments				
9.	**Welfare Expenditure (analysis on page 3)**				
10.	**Branch Ceremonial Events**		935		974
11.	**Management & Administration**				
	Conferences, Meetings & Travel				
	Audit				
	Branch Accommodation Costs				
	Other Costs	1634		2445	
	Total Management & Administration Costs		1634		2445
12.	**Purchases**				
	Stock of Badges, Wreaths etc		120		226
	Furniture & Equipment				
	Purchase of Investments (refer to Branch Guide)				
13.	**Other Payments**				
	Miscellaneous		500		304
	Debtor/Credtor movement		-310		-1510
	To Poppy Appeal		975		578
	To Other RBL Branches (.....Branch)				
	Donation to NMA				
	Other (entertaining)				464
14.	**Total Payments (add 9 to 13)**		€ 3 854		€ 3 481
15.	**Surplus/(Deficit) on Property Transactions**		-€ 6 397		-€ 6 458
16.	**Surplus/(Deficit) on General Account**		€ 952		€ 1 110
17.	**Opening Balance at 1 October**		€ 37 690		€ 36 580
18.	**Closing Balance at 30 June**		€ 38 642		€ 37 690

Branch Name	Paris, France

WELFARE ACCOUNT
FOR NINE MONTHS ENDED 30 JUNE 2013

Receipts

19.	Fundraising Receipts	16267	
	Fundraising Expenses	421	
	Net Funds Raised		15846
20.	**Monetary Gifts & Donations**		
20a.	**Legacy Income**		
21.	**Interest Received on Welfare A/c's**		
	Income From Investments		
22.	**Other Income**		
	Transfer From General Account		-975
23.	**Total receipts (add 19 to 22)**		€ 14 871

Payments

24.	**Direct Welfare Payments**	No. of Cases	£	
	Food			
	Fuel			
	Clothing			
	Bedding			
	Medical			
	Wheelchair/Stair lift			
	Phone			
	Housing (rent/mortgage)			
	Housing/Council Tax			
	Household Goods			
	Water Rates			
	Debt Clearance			
	TV. Licence			
	Car Transport/Running Costs			
	Motability Deposits			
	Education/Training			
	Property Repairs/Maintenance			
	Holidays for Disabled			
	Travel Costs			
	Removal Expenses			
	Hospital Visiting			
	Other Costs	1	93	
	Total Welfare Grants Paid			93
25.	**Donations Paid**			
	Total Donations Paid			
26.	**Other Charitable Payments**			
	British Charitable Fund			12500
27.	**Charitable Support Costs**			
	Administration Expenses			
	Welfare Expenses			
28.	**Total Payments (add 24 to 27)**			€ 12 593
29.	**Welfare Committee Expenses Refunded**			
30.	**Surplus/(Deficit) on Welfare Account**			€ 2 278
31.	**Opening Balance at 1 October**			€ 13 747
32.	**Closing Balance at 30 June**			€ 16 025

Branch Code	BR3441

PROPERTY TRANSACTIONS
FOR NINE MONTHS ENDED 30 JUNE 2013

Receipts

33.	**Rents Received from RBL Club**	
	Other Rents Received	
34.	**Other Receipts**	
35.	**Total Receipts (add 33 to 34)**	€ 0

Payments

36.	**Property Costs**		
	Rent Paid		
	Rates	1120	
	Property Insurance	453	
	Utilities	376	
	Property Repairs & Maintenance	2025	
	Property Improvements by Branch	1599	
	Cleaning & Caretakers	796	
	Legal & Professional Fees		
	Other (specify)		
	Sundry	28	
37.	**Total Payments**		€ 6 397
38.	**Transfer to/from General Account**		-€ 6 397
	Transfer to/from separate Property Fund		£

39. **Details of Branch Freehold/Leasehold Property**

Details of Property
28 rue des Acacias
75017 Paris
France

Is property Freehold or Leasehold ?	Freehold
Date Acquired (if known)	2009
Cost Price/Improvements to 30 June 2013	508662
Mortgage Outstanding at Year End	€ 0
Market Value at Year End*	€
Is the property owned by The Royal British Legion as Corporate Trustee?	No
Current Annual Rent Receivable	€ 0
Date of next Rent Review	
Name of Tenant	

For additional properties please continue on page 8

***Please leave blank - to be completed by Head Office**

Branch Name	SUMMARY OF BRANCH ASSETS AND LIABILITIES	Branch Code
Paris, France	AT 30 JUNE 2013	BR3441

			at 30 June 2013		at 30 Sept 2012	
40. BANK AND CASH BALANCES						
General Account						
Cash in Hand			€ 56		€ 0	
Accounts Held						
Please give details of financial institution, account number and sort code						
Barclays Paris	66174840101		1324		-1418	
	66174843001		37246		37905	
NatWest London	03046524		16		1203	
Branch Fund Initiative(BFI)						
Total for General Account (balance must agree to 18 on page 2)				€ 38 642		€ 37 690
Welfare Account						
Please give details of financial institution, account number and sort code						
Barclays Paris	66174840102		16025		13747	
Total for Welfare Account (balance must agree to 32 on page 3)				16025		€ 13 747
Other Funds (details on page 6 & 7)						
Trust funds held by Head Office*						
Other						
Total Bank and Cash Balances				€ 54 667		€ 51 437
41. FREEHOLD AND LEASEHOLD PROPERTY						
Estimated Market Value at 30 June 2013*/ 30 September 2012				€		€ 550 000
42. INVESTMENTS		Original Cost	Market Value			
Details						
Total Market Value at 30 June 2013/ 30 September 2012						
43. OTHER ASSETS						
Stock Items, Badges etc						
Furniture & Equipment				€ 5 261		€ 5 261
Other						
44. DEBTORS (money owed to Branch)						
By RBL						
Rents due from RBL Clubs						
Rents due from other Tenants						
Other debtors (please list)						
Prepayments			1775		1040	
Total Debtors				€ 1 775		€ 1 040
45. CREDITORS (money owed by Branch)						
To RBL						
Debentures			686		686	
Other creditors (please list)						
Accruals			730		1178	
Supplier					133	
Total Creditors				€ 1 416		€ 1 997
46. TOTAL NET ASSETS OF BRANCH (BOX 40+41*+42+43+44-45)				€		**€ 605 741**

***Please leave blank - to be completed at Head Office**

BRANCH ACCOUNTS

FOR THE NINE MONTHS ENDED 30 JUNE 2013

Continuation Sheet		
	Branch Name	Paris, France
	Branch Code	BR3441

Give details of any major transactions which took place after 30 June 2013 (refer to Branch Guide)
(if none state none)

NONE

Give details of any outstanding Guarantees given by the Branch, any future commitments entered into or contingent liabilities (refer to Branch Guide)
(if none state none)

NONE

Field Staff Comments

Finance Use Only

1. Recorded on CBA (please tick) ☐

2. Entered in SUN — Journal No

3. Other Observations

PROXY VOTING

As from September, 2005 the Privy Council have endorsed the Single Membership Charter Motion. This now entitles all members to vote and, if elected or appointed, to hold office or be a member of any Committee, provided that their Branch subscription is no more than 3 months in arrears. Therefore, at Branch Annual General Meetings now being held, all Members may vote and may be nominated for Officer or Committee posts at all levels. In the UK RBL rules do not provide for proxy ruling. In the case of the Paris Branch, where many members live some considerable distance from Paris, and who cannot attend the relevant meetings, such members may arrange for their proxy vote to be held by another member. A member so wishing to arrange for a proxy must personally obtain the approval of another member who is prepared to act as proxy, and then ensure that the duly completed proxy form is sent to the Secretary by Wednesday 20th November, 2013. Members may hold no more than two proxies each.

PROXY FORM

THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION
PARIS BRANCH

A.G.M. 25th NOVEMBER 2013

I _____ Paris Branch Member, will be absent from the Branch

AGM on Monday 25th November 2013, and hereby nominate _____

As my proxy at that meeting, in accordance with the above Proxy Voting Rules.

This form should be sent to the RBL Paris Branch Secretary at 28 rue des Acacias, 75017 Paris, to arrive no later than 20th November, 2013.

Signed _____

Dated _____

LE VOTE PAR PROCURATION

En Septembre 2005, le Conseil général a approuvé l'adoption de la Charte d'adhésion individuelle. Ceci donne le droit de vote désormais à tous les membres ainsi que le droit de remplir une fonction ou d'être élu ou nommé à un comité, pourvu que sa cotisation ait moins de 3 mois de retard. Ainsi, dorénavant, aux assemblées générales annuelles, tous les membres peuvent voter et peuvent être proposés pour des postes ou au Comité à tous les niveaux. La réglementation de la RBL au Royaume-Uni ne prévoit pas le vote par procuration. Dans le cas de la Section de Paris, puisque de nombreux membres résident à une distance considérable et ne peuvent assister aux réunions, il est permis d'organiser le vote par procuration. Un membre qui souhaite donner procuration doit personnellement obtenir l'accord d'un autre membre prêt à agir à sa place, puis s'assurer que le formulaire de procuration, dûment rempli, est envoyé au secrétaire pour arriver, au plus tard, le Mercredi 20 novembre 2013. Un membre ne peut détenir plus de deux procurations.

FORMULAIR DE PROCURATION

ROYAL BRITISH LEGION PARIS BRANCH

A.G.A. 25 novembre 2013

Moi _____ membre de la Section de Paris, serai absent de la AGA le

lundi 25 novembre 2013, et donne pouvoir, par la présente, à _____

pour voter à ma place par procuration lors de cette réunion, conformément aux règles ci-dessus.

Signature _____

Fai à _____ le (date) _____

Ce formulaire doit être envoyé au Secrétaire RBL Section de Paris au 28 rue des Acacias, 75017 Paris, pour arriver au plus tard le mercredi 20 novembre 2013.

THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION
PARIS BRANCH

Annual General Meeting, 2013/Assemblée Annuelle

Nominations

Chairman/Président _____

Proposer/Proposé par _____ Seconder/Soutenu par _____

Vice-Chairman/Vice Président _____

Proposer/Proposé par _____ Seconder/Soutenu par _____

Hon. Tresurer/Tresorier _____

Proposer/Proposé par _____ Seconder/Soutenu par _____

Hon. Secretary/Secretaire _____

Proposer/Proposé par _____ Seconder/Soutenu par _____

COMMITTEE NOMINATIONS/NOMINATIONS AU COMITE

Name/Nom _____Proposer/Proposé par _____ Seconder/Soutenu _____

Name/Nom _____ Proposer/Proposé par _____ Seconder/Soutenu _____

Name/Nom _____ Proposer/Proposé par _____ Seconder/Soutenu _____

Name/Nom _____ Proposer/Proposé par _____ Seconder/Soutenu _____

Name/Nom _____ Proposer/Proposé par _____ Seconder/Soutenu _____

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Name/Nom _____ Proposer/Proposé par _____ Seconder/Soutenu _____